BUSINESS BANK · BUSINESS BANKING TRANSFORMATION OFFICE · BB-BLP-BPR

1.9 Pain-Point Register and Root-Cause Analysis

What is wrong, how we found it, how often it happens, and why

Deliverable	1.9 Pain-point register tagged to process, with root-cause analysis on the top ten themes
Version	0.7 – 43 pain points identified from the current-state maps, RFP, control and workaround inventories (Week 3); frequency and impact bands indicative. Scores confirmed in workshops WS-02 to WS-14, interviews and survey free text; measured frequencies from 1.4 → v1.0 at Week 7
Source	1.2 maps (observations); 1.3 matrix; 1.6 control failure modes; 1.7 workaround risks; 1.8 data risks; RFP; sponsor interviews W1; hypothesis tree 0.6
Owner	WS1 Journeys & Process (BPR/TOM Lead)
Accepted by	Business Owner; reviewed by working-group leads
Feeds	1.10 opportunity long-list (one or more opportunities per root cause); 1.11 current-state report; Phase 2 design principles

1. How the pain points were found

A pain-point register is only as good as the method that produced it. Two failure modes are common: a list of complaints collected in workshops (loud, not representative) or a list of system defects (technical, not business). We used a structured approach with five sources, three lenses and a fixed question bank, so that every entry can be traced to where it came from and why it qualifies.

1.1 Sources and sequence

#	Source	When	What it contributes	Bias it carries	Corrected by
S1	Hypothesis tree (0.6)	W1–2	Where to look: 20 falsifiable claims about what is wrong	Confirmation bias: we find what we look for	Lens 3 (data) and workshop prompts that invite disconfirmation
S2	Current-state maps, read against three lenses (§1.2)	W3	Structural pain points visible in the process itself: loops, hand-offs, manual steps, missing paths	Maps show design intent, not practice	Walk-the-process and workshops
S3	Control and workaround inventories (1.6, 1.7)	W3	Failure modes of controls; gaps that workarounds cover	Technical framing	Impact scored in business terms
S4	Voice of business: interviews (15–20), workshops (14), shadowing (5 days), survey free text (“biggest time-waster today”)	W3–6	Frequency, impact, practice vs. design, pain points not visible in maps	Loudest voice; recency; functional view	Fixed question bank; every pain point tagged to L2 and step; triangulated across roles
S5	Measurement (1.4, 1.5)	W5–7	Measured frequency and cost for pain points with a metric	Only measures what is captured	Register flags unmeasurable items explicitly

At v0.7 the register rests on S1–S3. The frequency and impact bands are therefore *indicative*: derived from RFP volumes and the position of the step in the flow, not from testimony or measurement. S4 and S5 convert them to confirmed bands and, where a metric exists, to numbers.

1.2 Three lenses applied to every map

Each of the 28 maps was read three times, once per lens, with a fixed set of questions. A pain point is recorded only if at least one question is answered “yes” with a specific step reference.

Lens	Looks for	Questions asked of every map	Waste codes
1. Flow (lean, adapted to lending)	Waste in the sequence of work	Where does the deal wait, and on whom? · Which steps are performed on every deal regardless of risk or change? · Where does work leave the system (email, message, report, spreadsheet)? · Where does the deal loop back, and is the loop bounded? · Which steps are repeated across journeys? · Where is work handed between teams, and what does the receiver see?	W, O, D, H, M, I
2. Control	Controls that are weak, undocumented, misplaced or defeated	What is this step protecting against, and is that written anywhere? · Is the control performed on data the system already holds? · Is it placed where it can act earliest? · Can it be defeated by a workaround (off-platform document, field combination)? · Is a decision made without a documented criterion? · Is the outcome recorded with a reason?	C

3. Data and transparency	What cannot be seen, measured or trusted	Can management see where this deal is and how long it has been there? · Is the field captured once, at source, in a structured form? · Would a report keyed on this field be correct? · Is effort or elapsed time measurable at this step? · Is there a reason code where a decision is recorded?	T, U

1.3 Qualification rule

An observation becomes a pain point only if it meets all three tests: (a) it is tied to a specific process step or rule, not a general complaint; (b) it has a plausible business consequence in at least one of five dimensions (cycle time, cost/effort, risk/control, customer experience, colleague experience); (c) it is distinguishable from a preference ("I would like a different screen layout" fails; "the landing page shows no work due so renewals start late" passes).

1.4 Scoring

Dimension	Band 1	Band 2	Band 3	Band 4	Band 5
Frequency (deals or events affected per year)	< 100	100–1,000	1,000–5,000	5,000–15,000	> 15,000 or every deal
Impact (worst of the five dimensions)	Minutes; cosmetic	Hours of effort or days of delay; no risk	Days of delay or material effort; or MI distortion	Weeks of delay, rework of a stage, or control weakness	Re-approval, regulatory or conduct exposure, or customer loss

Score = Frequency × Impact (1–25). Evidence strength is recorded separately and does not change the score; it determines how much validation the item needs. Scores are a ranking device for choosing root-cause themes, not a benefits estimate; sizing happens in 1.10.

2. Question bank used in discovery

The same questions were put to every role, in the same order, so that answers can be compared across RM, Credit, Lending Services, Fulfilment and SBS. Role-specific probes follow the core set. Interviewers record the step reference for every answer; an answer without a step reference goes to the parking lot.

2.1 Voice-of-business interview guide (45 min)

> **Opening (5 min).** Your role, segment, how many deals you touch in a typical week, which deal types.

> **Walk a deal (15 min).** Take the last renewal [variation / new money] you completed. From the moment you knew it was needed to the moment the customer could use the facility: what happened, in order? Where did it wait, and on whom? What did you do outside BLP? What did you have to do twice?

> **Time (10 min).** Of your working week, roughly what share is on: new business, renewals and variations, chasing (customers, Credit, other teams), system admin and re-keying, customer relationship time not tied to a deal? What would you stop doing tomorrow if you could?

> **Controls (5 min).** Which checks do you perform because policy requires them, and which because "that's how it's done"? Have you ever been unsure whether a deal was within your authority? What happens when a customer changes their mind after approval?

> **Failure (5 min).** Think of a deal that went wrong or took far too long. What happened? What would have prevented it?

> **Close (5 min).** If the new platform could do one thing BLP cannot, what would it be? Who else should we speak to?

2.2 Role-specific probes

Role	Probes	Targets
RM / Business Direct	How do you know a renewal is due? How do you issue a facility letter and know it has come back? What does Credit most often send back, and why? Which variations do you know Credit will wave through?	PP-04, 23, 13, 18
Credit	What share of your queue is renewals with no change? What is missing from submissions most often? Do you see the same deal again after deferral? How do you spot distress?	PP-09, 13, 14, 17
Lending Services / Securities	How does an instruction reach you? How long from instruction to complete, by security type? Where do you record progress? Is security re-instructed when nothing has changed?	PP-27, 28, 30
Fulfilment	How do you know a deal is ready? How many are waiting now, and how do you know? What arrives incomplete?	PP-29, 26
SBS / PS	What triggers a referral? How long from referral to categorisation? What do you re-read that Credit already read? Where is the strategy memo written?	PP-34, 21, 35
MI / Reg Reporting	Which reports take BLP data? What do you correct by hand each cycle, and why? What breaks when a deal type is used wrongly?	PP-40, 08, 37

2.3 Workshop prompts (per map, after walk-through)

1. Is this what actually happens? Where does practice differ from the map?
2. Point to every place the deal waits. On whom? For how long, typically and at worst?
3. Which steps would you remove if Credit Risk let you? Which would Credit Risk never let you remove, and why?
4. Where does work leave BLP? (email, Word, Excel, phone, another system)
5. What is the most common reason this journey restarts or loops?
6. What differs by segment (Business Direct / Strategic Finance / Corporate)?
7. What is missing from this map altogether?

2.4 Shadowing observation checklist (per observed instance)

Step performed · system or tool used · start and stop time · interruptions · re-keying observed (from where to where) · documents produced outside the system · hand-off method · what the person said they were waiting for · deviation from the map.

2.5 Survey free text

One line per respondent per day: “Biggest time-waster today.” Coded to L2 and waste type in Week 6; counts by role feed frequency bands.

3. Pain-point register (v0.7)

F = frequency band · I = impact band · Score = F × I (indicative, pre-validation) · Ev: M maps · R RFP · C controls · X matrix · H hypothesis tree · I interviews W1 · Waste: see §1.2

ID	Pain point	L2	Where	Roles	Waste	F	I	Score	Ev	Hyp.	Note / measure
ORIGINATE											
PP-01	Leads are unmanaged: no lead register, no SLA from enquiry to first contact, no record of leads that never become deals	1.1	NM-1 R0	RM, BD	Data / transparency gap	3	3	**9**	M, I	—	Lost leads and response time invisible
PP-02	Initial overview (pre-screen) has no documented criteria and declines at this point are not recorded with a reason	1.1	NM-1 D3 (C0)	RM	Control gap	3	3	**9**	M, C	—	Conduct exposure (RR-07); inconsistency by RM
PP-03	The same five-step deal start (login, landing page, search, locate, retrieve) is performed manually on every deal; landing page surfaces no work due	1.3	All *-1 S1–S4	RM, BD, SBS	Motion / navigation	5	2	**10**	M, X	B1	c. 26,700 repetitions a year
PP-04	Renewal is triggered by a report (BDRM), not a system task; renewals start late and lateness is unmeasured	4.1	RN-1 S0 (W-11)	RM, BD	Waiting	5	4	**20**	M, R	—	14,857 renewals / yr; T7 to measure
PP-05	Any party change diverts a renewal into the Variation journey, so a renewal with a changed guarantor is processed as a restructure	4.1	RN-1 D1	RM	Over-processing	2	3	**6**	M	B2	Share unknown
PP-06	Opportunity record adds a step without adding information; source notes deals should be creatable without it	1.2	NM-1 S7	RM	Over-processing	2	1	**2**	M	—	New/Increase only
PP-07	Existing balances are sourced from MEO / IMPACS with latency; credit submission may carry stale balances	1.4	*-2 S2 (W-21)	RM	Data / transparency gap	5	2	**10**	M, R	D1	Latency TBC with Technology
PP-08	Deal-type model is worked around: 3 of 11 types carry no live process; allocations recorded as Staged Drawdown + Variation request type; removals recorded as Variation; ESR Cleanse records migration as deals	1.4	1.3 §5; W-16/17/18/23	RM, MI	Data / transparency gap	5	4	**20**	R, M, X	B3	12.5% of volume is non-customer; MI misclassified
DECIDE											
PP-09	Renewals follow the full Deal & Credit flow (analysis, validation, document check, authority check, Credit assessment) although by definition they involve no structural change	2.1–2.4	RN-2 (= NM-2)	RM, Credit	Over-processing	5	5	**25**	M, R, X	A1, A2	Largest single over-processing item by volume
PP-10	“Credit analytics if required” on renewals and variations has no stated criterion; application varies by RM	2.1	RN-2 R3; VA-2 R3	RM	Control gap	4	3	**12**	M	E1	Inconsistent risk coverage
PP-11	Credit analytics (debt servicing, classifications, external checks) are prepared off-platform and keyed into BLP; analysis is not evidenced in the system	2.1	*-2 R3 (W-10, C2)	RM	Defect / rework	5	3	**15**	M, C	D1	Confirm tools in walk-the-process
PP-12	Requests to the customer for information are made and chased outside the system; nothing records what was asked, when, or what is outstanding	2.1	*-2 C1	RM, customer	Waiting	5	3	**15**	M	C1	Customer-side wait inside S1
PP-13	Deal validation does not catch what Credit needs: deals pass validation and are then deferred for missing information	2.2	*-2 R4 (C3) → EX-02	RM, Credit	Defect / rework	4	4	**16**	M, C	C1	R1 to measure; root cause of PP-14

PP-14	The deferral loop (Credit → RM → customer → Credit) is unbounded: no limit on count or elapsed time, no structured request, no guarantee of the same assessor on resubmission	2.4	EX-02	Credit, RM	Defect / rework	4	4	**16**	M	C1	R2, R3 to measure
PP-15	Delegated-authority determination is manual: the RM reads the matrix and routes the deal, although limit, exposure and grade are held in BLP	2.3	*-2 D2 (C5, W-19)	RM	Control gap	5	4	**20**	M, C	E2	Breach risk; inconsistency; c. 25,900 / yr
PP-16	The Credit queue is invisible: no SLA, no queue position, no visibility for the RM or customer of where a deal is	2.4	*-2 S4 (S2a)	Credit, RM	Waiting	4	4	**16**	M	C4	T4 to measure
PP-17	The financial-distress screen sits after full Credit assessment and applies to existing customers only, so distressed cases consume a full review before referral	2.4 / 5.2	*-2 D3 (C7)	Credit	Over-processing	2	4	**8**	M	—	L10 cycle-time driver
PP-18	Variations are not triaged by materiality: a covenant date change and a security restructure follow the same path	4.2	VA-2	RM, Credit	Over-processing	5	4	**20**	M, R	A4	7,277 / yr; reason taxonomy to build
PP-19	A customer change after approval sends the deal back for re-processing with no materiality rule; minor changes may trigger full re-approval	2.6	EX-03 (C22)	RM, Credit	Defect / rework	2	3	**6**	M	C3	R5 to measure
PP-20	Decline, appeal and refer have no defined process: reasons may not be recorded, appeal route and “refer” destination are undocumented	2.5	EX-01 (C20, C21)	RM, Credit	Control gap	2	4	**8**	M	—	Conduct and MI exposure
PP-21	A CAP referral passes two sequential authorities (Credit, then SBS) each reviewing the same memo before anything changes for the customer	5.2	CR-2 D1, D2 (C13, C14)	Credit, SBS	Hand-off	2	4	**8**	M	—	T8 to measure; 794 / yr
PP-22	Extension Pending Review is used as a holding pattern: chains of up to three EPRs precede a renewal that happens anyway	4.1	RN-3 note	RM, Credit	Defect / rework	3	3	**9**	R, M	A3	1,919 EPRs / yr; R6 to measure
DOCUMENT & FULFIL											
PP-23	Facility letters are generated in BLP but issued manually by the RM as a PDF by email or post; sent and returned status is not captured; evidence of issue is an RM mailbox	3.1	*-3 S2 (W-06)	RM, Bus Ops	Defect / rework	5	5	**25**	M, R	C2, D3	c. 25,000 letters / yr; source states preference to automate
PP-24	A facility letter not returned within three months sends the deal back to pre-credit: a full re-approval for a timing failure	3.1	*-3 C1 → R1	RM, Credit, customer	Defect / rework	3	5	**15**	M	C2	R4 to measure
PP-25	Facility letters for Staged Drawdown (confirmed) and Shadow Limit (to confirm) are produced off-platform, so the platform does not hold the agreed terms and the document check cannot reconcile to system data	3.1 / 4.3	SL-2, SD-1, SD-2 (W-07/08)	RM	Control gap	1	4	**4**	M	D2	Control C4 defeated
PP-26	Three completion conditions (letter complete, pre-conditions met, security complete) must converge before fulfilment but there is no single view of which is outstanding	3.3	*-3 S3–S6 (C9)	RM	Data / transparency gap	4	3	**12**	M	C4	Pre-conditions is a single flag
PP-27	Security preparation is a sub-process box: instruction channel, queue, elapsed time and registration tracking are all invisible	3.2	EX-05 (W-13)	RM, Lending Services	Waiting	3	4	**12**	M	C4	Likely longest parallel path
PP-28	Security is re-instructed to Lending Services on every variation, including those where security does not change (to confirm)	3.2	VA-3 R3	RM, Lending Services	Over-processing	4	2	**8**	M	A4	May be a drawing default
PP-29	Hand-off to Fulfilment is by message; the Fulfilment queue and its SLA are invisible in BLP	3.4	*-3 R5 (W-12)	RM, Fulfilment	Hand-off	5	3	**15**	M	C4	T6 to measure

PP-30	Facility removal needs four messages (to Securities, back; to Fulfilment, back) for one outcome, and the system releases security before the Securities Team confirms physical release	4.4	RF-2	RM, Securities, Fulfilment	Hand-off	2	3	**6**	M	—	Sequence to confirm
PP-31	A shadow-limit reallocation issues two or more full facility letters (reduced limit plus each new facility), each manually issued and each subject to the 3-month reset	4.3	SR-2	RM	Over-processing	1	2	**2**	M	—	62 / yr
PP-32	Who checks the returned renewal letter depends on segment (RM / Business Ops / Corporate Associate); the only segment variation shown, suggesting others are undocumented	3.1	RN-3 R2	RM, Bus Ops, Corp Assoc	Data / transparency gap	4	2	**8**	M	—	WS-14
PP-33	Whether a renewal letter must be signed is a decision with no stated rule	3.1	RN-3 D1	RM	Control gap	4	2	**8**	M	—	Rule to extract
MONITOR & RECOVER											
PP-34	The trigger for a CAP referral is undefined: RM judgement, arrears, covenant breach or Credit flag, none systematised; early-warning data in BLP is not used to prompt referral	5.2	CR-1 R0	RM, Credit	Control gap	2	5	**10**	M	—	L10; risk cost
PP-35	The CAP Strategy memo is written off-platform and attached; strategy content is unstructured and not reportable	5.3	CS-2 B4 (W-09)	SBS	Data / transparency gap	2	3	**6**	M	D2	722 / yr
PP-36	Covenant and waiver lifecycle is run by a batch job; no RM task is generated on expiry or breach	5.1	W-03	RM	Control gap	3	3	**9**	R	D1	No source map for 5.1
PP-37	Officer codes are reassigned in bulk by batch with no audit trail on the deal; segment attribution in MI drifts	E2.3	W-04	MI, SBS	Data / transparency gap	2	3	**6**	R	D1, F2	C26, C27 exposure
CROSS-CUTTING											
PP-38	Deals not progressed in 90 days are reset to origination by batch with no warning to the RM; work is lost and restarts are counted as new deals	2.6 / E2.1	W-01	RM, MI	Defect / rework	3	3	**9**	R	D1	R8 to measure
PP-39	There are no workflow timers, SLAs or escalations anywhere in the lifecycle; every wait is open-ended and invisible	all	all maps	all	Waiting	5	4	**20**	M, X	C4	Root cause of PP-04, 14, 16, 27, 29
PP-40	Regulatory reporting lineage from BLP is undocumented at field level and operational MI relies on manual adjustment	E2.4	1.8	MI, Reg Reporting	Data / transparency gap	2	4	**8**	R, H	F1, F2	Redesign risk
PP-41	A discontinued deal type (DO NOT USE) remains selectable	E2.3	W-23 (I-02)	RM	Control gap	1	1	**1**	R	—	Quick win
PP-42	Deposit opportunities are closed as Won / Declined with no reason code and no pipeline MI; rate exceptions approved outside BLP	E1.1	DP-1	RM	Data / transparency gap	1	2	**2**	R, M	—	SD-03
PP-43	Effort is invisible: BLP records no touch time, so cost to serve, capacity and the effect of any change cannot be measured without a survey	E2.4	1.5	Leadership, Finance	Data / transparency gap	5	3	**15**	R	—	Why 1.5 exists

4. Prioritisation

4.1 Top 15 by indicative score

Rank	ID	Pain point (short)	F	I	Score	Cum. share	RCA theme
1	**PP-09**	Renewals follow the full Deal & Credit flow (analysis, validation, document check, authority check, Credit ass...	5	5	**25**	5%	RC-01
2	**PP-23**	Facility letters are generated in BLP but issued manually by the RM as a PDF by email or post...	5	5	**25**	10%	RC-02
3	**PP-04**	Renewal is triggered by a report (BDRM), not a system task	5	4	**20**	15%	RC-05
4	**PP-08**	Deal-type model is worked around...	5	4	**20**	19%	RC-06
5	**PP-15**	Delegated-authority determination is manual...	5	4	**20**	23%	RC-04
6	**PP-18**	Variations are not triaged by materiality...	5	4	**20**	27%	RC-07
7	**PP-39**	There are no workflow timers, SLAs or escalations anywhere in the lifecycle...	5	4	**20**	31%	RC-05
8	**PP-13**	Deal validation does not catch what Credit needs...	4	4	**16**	35%	RC-03
9	**PP-14**	The deferral loop (Credit → RM → customer → Credit) is unbounded...	4	4	**16**	38%	RC-03
10	**PP-16**	The Credit queue is invisible...	4	4	**16**	41%	RC-05
11	**PP-11**	Credit analytics (debt servicing, classifications, external checks) are prepared off-platform and keyed into B...	5	3	**15**	44%	RC-03
12	**PP-12**	Requests to the customer for information are made and chased outside the system...	5	3	**15**	47%	RC-03
13	**PP-24**	A facility letter not returned within three months sends the deal back to pre-credit...	3	5	**15**	51%	RC-02
14	**PP-29**	Hand-off to Fulfilment is by message	5	3	**15**	54%	RC-05
15	**PP-43**	Effort is invisible...	5	3	**15**	57%	RC-10

The top 15 of 43 pain points carry 57% of the total indicative score. All fifteen fall within the ten root-cause themes in section 5; no high-scoring pain point is an orphan.

4.2 Heat map: score by lifecycle stage × waste type

Stage	Waiting	Over-processing	Defect / rework	Hand-off	Motion / navigation	Control gap	Data / transparency gap	Total
1.x Originate		2			10	9	39	**60**
2.x Decide	31	33	62			40		**166**
3.x Document & Fulfil	12	8	40	15		12	20	**107**
4.x Service	20	28	9	6				**63**
5.x Monitor & Recover				8		19	6	**33**

E Enabling / all	20					1	31	**52**
Total	**83**	**71**	**111**	**29**	**10**	**81**	**96**	**481**

Reading the heat map. The weight sits in Decide (over-processing and rework) and Document & Fulfil (rework and waiting). Control gaps are spread across every stage, which is why 1.6 is a Phase 2 gating document rather than a side register. The Service row is light only because servicing pain points are tagged to the Decide and Document processes they pass through; by journey, Renewal and Variation carry the majority of every column.

4.3 Score by role most affected

Role	Pain points	Sum of scores	Largest
RM	36	410	PP-09
Credit	12	157	PP-09
Lending Services	2	20	PP-27
Fulfilment	2	21	PP-29
SBS	4	30	PP-03
MI	4	43	PP-08

5. Root-cause analysis

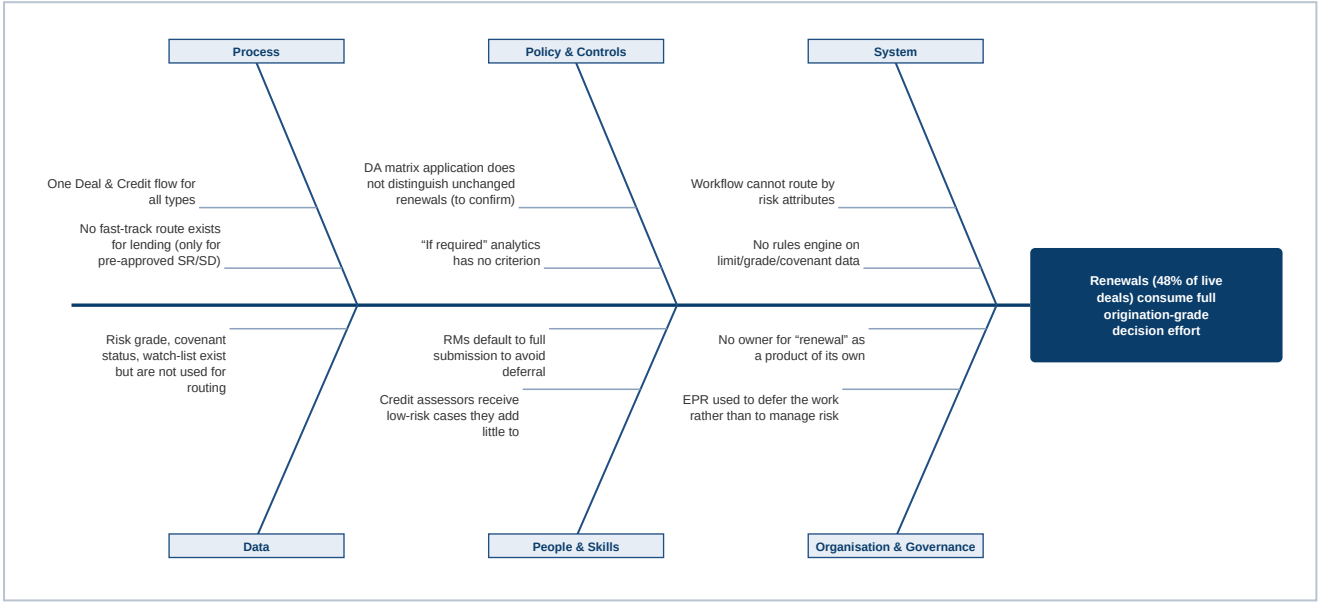
Ten themes cover the top-scoring pain points. For each: the effect (the pain as the business experiences it), a cause-and-effect (fishbone) diagram on six bones adapted to a bank process, a five-whys chain to the root, the root cause stated in one line, and the levers in the benefits tree (0.9) that address it.

Bone	Meaning in a lending process
Process	Sequence, steps, loops, hand-offs as designed and as practised
Policy & Controls	Credit policy, delegated authority, control requirements and how they are expressed
System	BLP capability and configuration; integrations; workarounds
Data	What is captured, where, in what form; what is missing or wrong
People & Skills	Judgement, habit, capability, incentives at the individual level
Organisation & Governance	Ownership, measurement, team boundaries, decision rights

Rule for the five whys: stop when the answer is something the project can change or must explicitly accept, not before. Several chains end at the same place (effort is unmeasured; policy lives in documents; the system has no concept of time), which is the point: fewer root causes than pain points.

RC-01 · Renewals (48% of live deals) consume full origination-grade decision effort

Pain points	**PP-09** (25) Renewals follow the full Deal & Credit flow (analysis, validation, document check, authori... **PP-10** (12) “Credit analytics if required” on renewals and variations has no stated criterion; applica... **PP-22** (9) Extension Pending Review is used as a holding pattern: chains of up to three EPRs precede ...
Combined score	46



Five whys

1. Why do renewals take the full path? → Because the workflow has a single Deal & Credit path for every deal type.
2. Why a single path? → Because BLP routes by deal type, not by risk, and deal type “Renewal” was built as a copy of New Money.
3. Why not by risk? → Because no rules engine exists and the DA determination is manual, so routing cannot use data the system holds.
4. Why is the determination manual? → Because the DA matrix is a document and nobody specified it as rules when BLP was configured.
5. Why was it not specified? → Because the original implementation replicated the paper process (“paving the cow path”), which is the risk this project exists to avoid on the replacement.

Root cause

> **Routing is by deal type, not by risk; the delegated-authority policy was never expressed as system rules**

Levers (0.9)

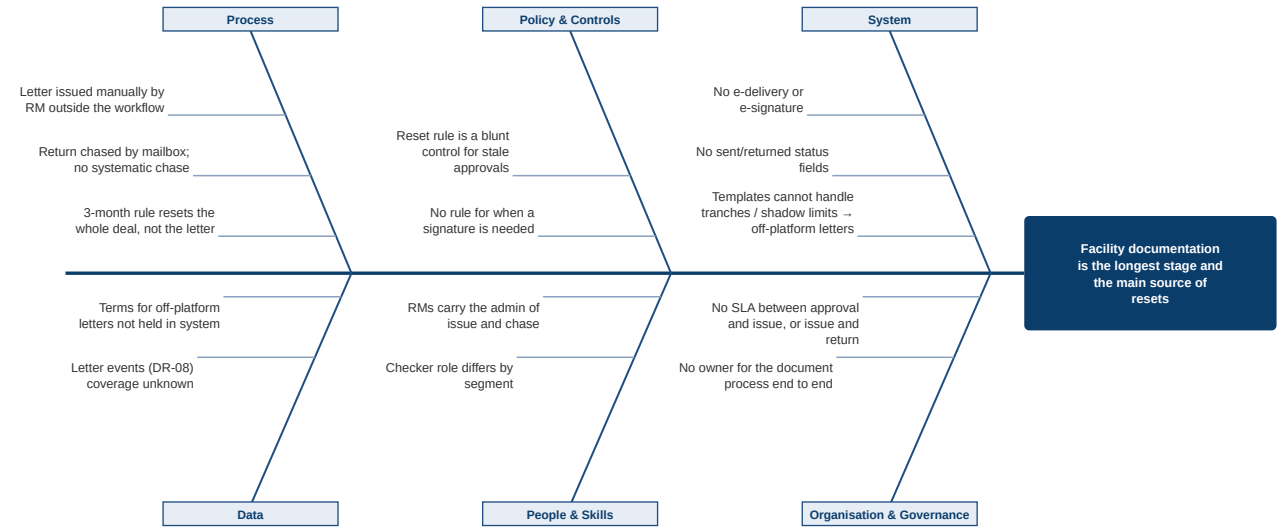
L1, L3

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points’ maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-02 · Facility documentation is the longest stage and the main source of resets

Pain points	**PP-23** (25) Facility letters are generated in BLP but issued manually by the RM as a PDF by email or p... **PP-24** (15) A facility letter not returned within three months sends the deal back to pre-credit: a fu... **PP-25** (4) Facility letters for Staged Drawdown (confirmed) and Shadow Limit (to confirm) are produce... **PP-31** (2) A shadow-limit reallocation issues two or more full facility letters (reduced limit plus e... **PP-33** (8) Whether a renewal letter must be signed is a decision with no stated rule...
Combined score	54



Five whys

1. Why is documentation the longest stage? → Because the customer-side wait for a returned letter is unmanaged.
2. Why unmanaged? → Because once the RM emails the PDF, BLP has no status to track and nothing prompts a chase.
3. Why no status? → Because issue happens outside BLP; the platform generates the letter but cannot deliver or receive it.
4. Why outside? → Because BLP has no delivery or e-signature capability and templates cannot cover all products, so RMs built a manual routine.
5. Why does a late letter reset the deal? → Because the only control against stale approvals is a hard reset, with no intermediate chase or extension step.

Root cause

> **Document delivery and execution were never part of the system process; the only control on staleness is a reset**

Levers (0.9)

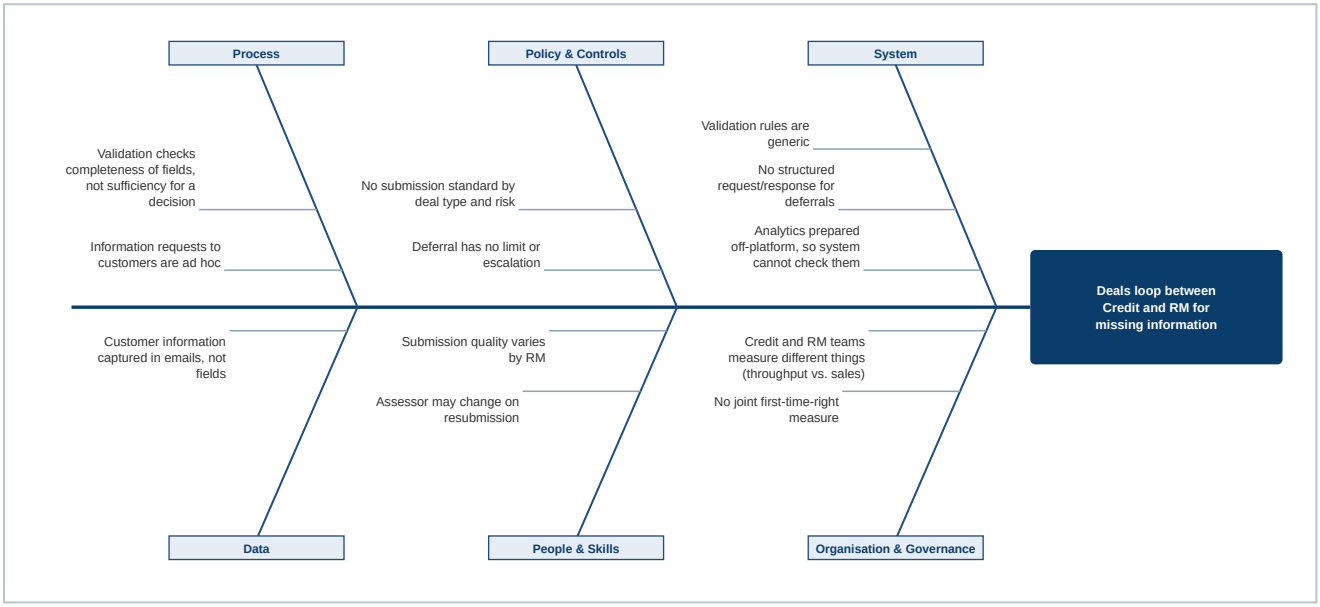
L4

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-03 · Deals loop between Credit and RM for missing information

Pain points	**PP-13** (16) Deal validation does not catch what Credit needs: deals pass validation and are then defer... **PP-14** (16) The deferral loop (Credit → RM → customer → Credit) is unbounded: no limit on count or ela... **PP-12** (15) Requests to the customer for information are made and chased outside the system; nothing r... **PP-11** (15) Credit analytics (debt servicing, classifications, external checks) are prepared off-platf...
Combined score	62



Five whys

1. Why do deals defer? → Because Credit finds information missing or insufficient after submission.
2. Why after submission? → Because validation (C3) checks that fields are populated, not that the submission meets Credit's standard for that deal type.
3. Why no standard? → Because the required-items list is tacit knowledge in Credit, not a rule in the system or a checklist for RMs.
4. Why tacit? → Because analytics are prepared off-platform and the system holds only the outputs, so a standard could not be enforced even if written.
5. Why unbounded? → Because the loop was drawn as an arrow, never designed as a path with limits and owners.

Root cause

> **No enforceable submission standard; the deferral loop was never designed, only tolerated**

Levers (0.9)

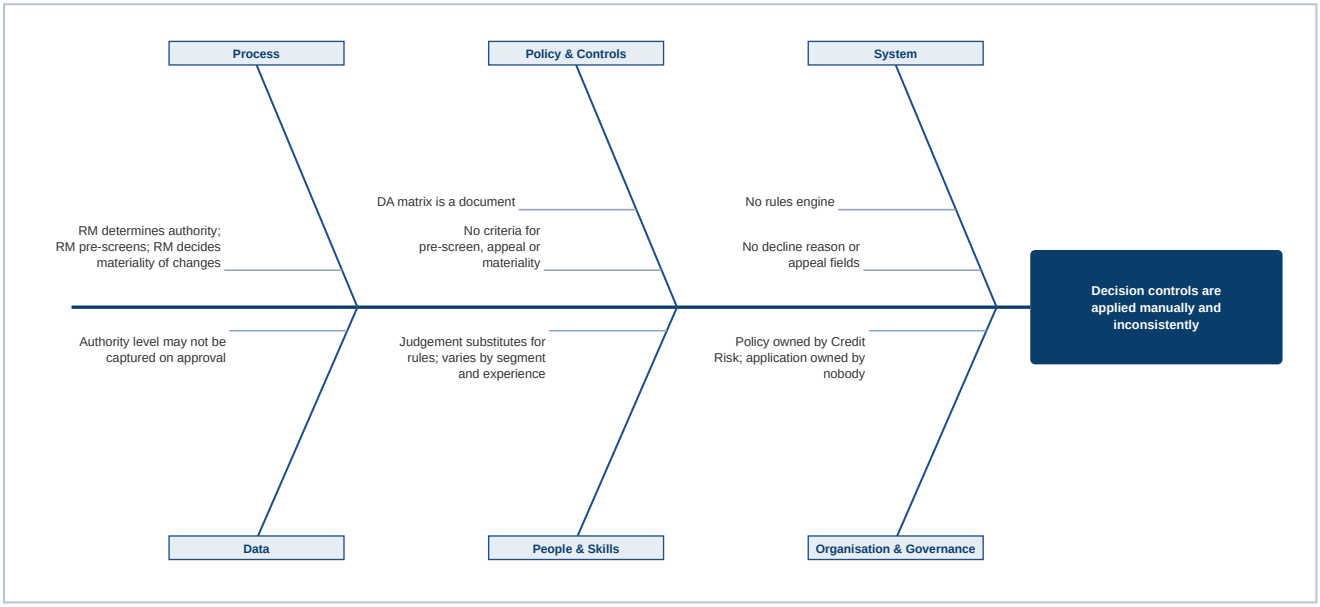
L11, L5

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-04 · Decision controls are applied manually and inconsistently

Pain points	**PP-15** (20) Delegated-authority determination is manual: the RM reads the matrix and routes the deal, ... **PP-02** (9) Initial overview (pre-screen) has no documented criteria and declines at this point are no... **PP-20** (8) Decline, appeal and refer have no defined process: reasons may not be recorded, appeal rou... **PP-19** (6) A customer change after approval sends the deal back for re-processing with no materiality...
Combined score	43



Five whys

1. Why manual? → Because the policy exists as a document and the system has nowhere to hold it as rules.
2. Why nowhere? → Because BLP's workflow was configured for statuses, not decisions.
3. Why not changed since? → Because every change to BLP is vendor-supported and costly, and the manual routine "works" until a breach.
4. Why is the gap tolerated? → Because breaches are not reported systematically (no authority field), so the control failure is invisible.
5. Why invisible? → Because evidence of authority is the approver's name, not a recorded level against a recorded rule.

Root cause

> **Policy lives in documents and judgement, not in system rules with recorded evidence**

Levers (0.9)

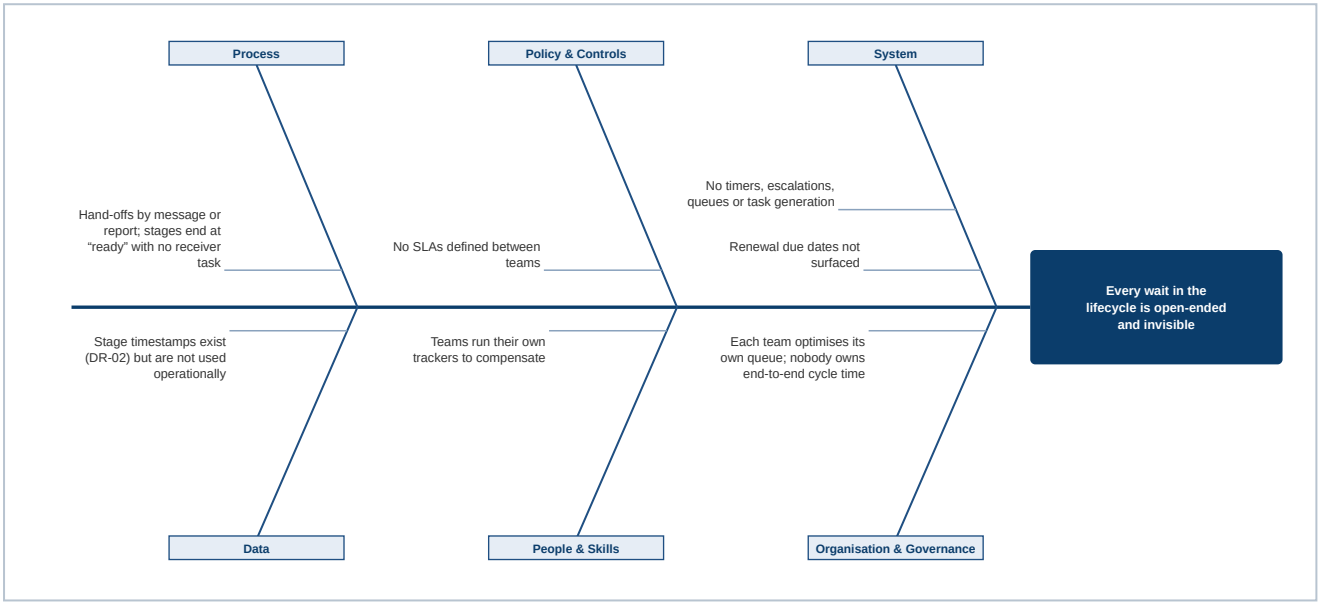
L3, L9

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-05 · Every wait in the lifecycle is open-ended and invisible

Pain points	**PP-39** (20) There are no workflow timers, SLAs or escalations anywhere in the lifecycle; every wait is... **PP-16** (16) The Credit queue is invisible: no SLA, no queue position, no visibility for the RM or cust... **PP-29** (15) Hand-off to Fulfilment is by message; the Fulfilment queue and its SLA are invisible in BL... **PP-27** (12) Security preparation is a sub-process box: instruction channel, queue, elapsed time and re... **PP-04** (20) Renewal is triggered by a report (BDRM), not a system task; renewals start late and latene...
Combined score	83



Five whys

1. Why are waits invisible? → Because BLP has no queue or SLA view and hand-offs leave the system.
2. Why do hand-offs leave the system? → Because workflow stages end at the sending team; the receiving team has no task.
3. Why no task? → Because BLP has no cross-team work management; each team compensates with a tracker.
4. Why tolerated? → Because nobody owns end-to-end cycle time; each function reports its own.
5. Why no owner? → Because performance management is by function, and the process has never been measured end to end (1.4 is the first baseline).

Root cause

> **Work management and end-to-end ownership are absent; the system has no concept of time**

Levers (0.9)

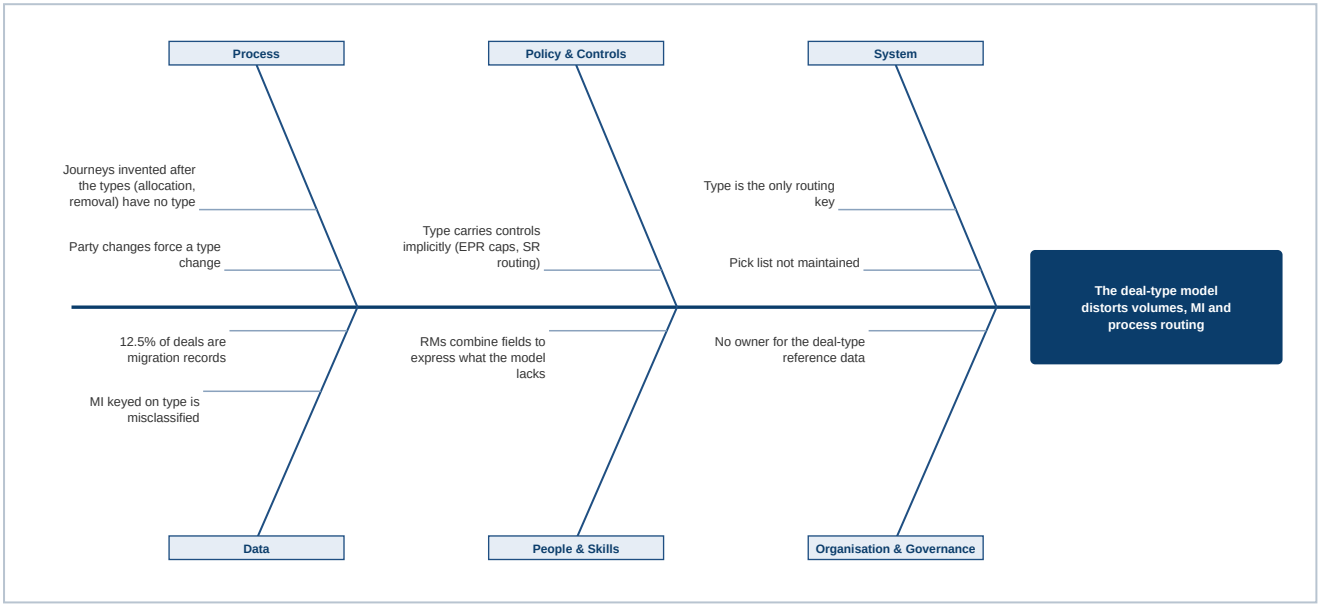
L5, L7 (timers native), L2

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-06 · The deal-type model distorts volumes, MI and process routing

Pain points	**PP-08** (20) Deal-type model is worked around: 3 of 11 types carry no live process; allocations recorde... **PP-41** (1) A discontinued deal type (DO NOT USE) remains selectable... **PP-05** (6) Any party change diverts a renewal into the Variation journey, so a renewal with a changed...
Combined score	27



Five whys

1. Why are types worked around? → Because the model was fixed at implementation and journeys evolved.
2. Why not extended? → Because adding a type is a vendor change; combining fields is free.
3. Why does it matter? → Because type drives routing, controls and MI, so a workaround in one distorts all three.
4. Why 11 types? → Because each business event got its own type rather than a parameter on a pattern.
5. Why? → Because nobody separated journey (what happens) from controls (what must be true), which 1.3 now does.

Root cause

> **Journey and control were conflated into a rigid type model with no owner**

Levers (0.9)

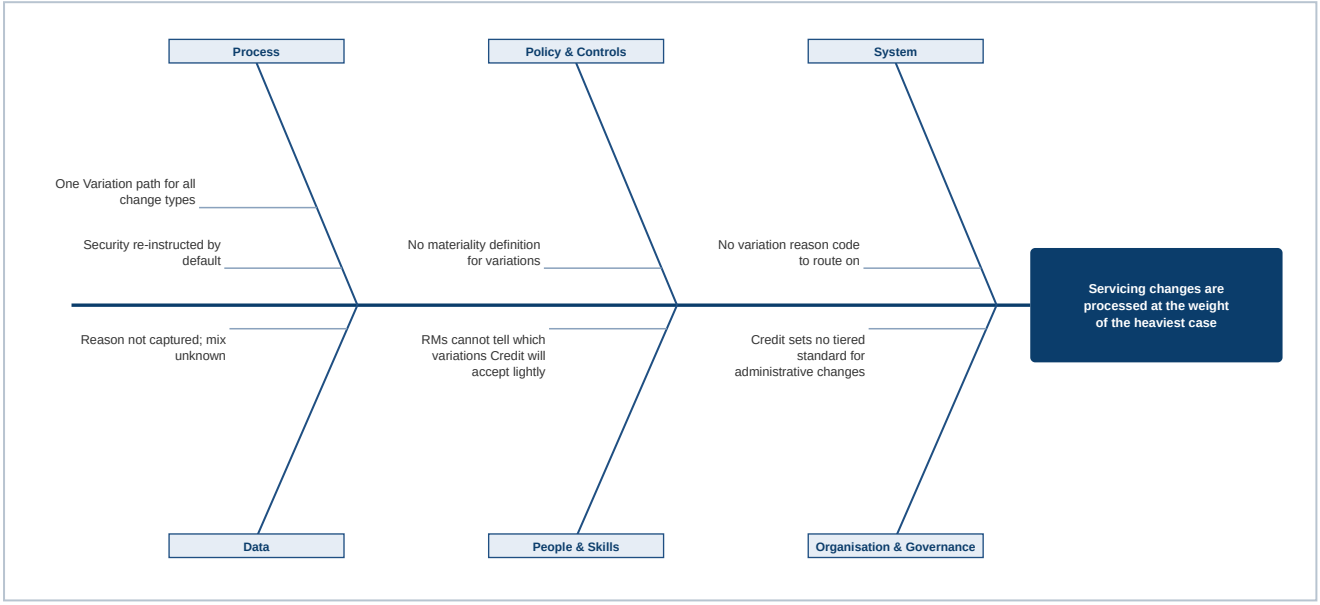
L12, L6

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-07 · Servicing changes are processed at the weight of the heaviest case

Pain points	**PP-18** (20) Variations are not triaged by materiality: a covenant date change and a security restructu... **PP-28** (8) Security is re-instructed to Lending Services on every variation, including those where se... **PP-30** (6) Facility removal needs four messages (to Securities, back; to Fulfilment, back) for one ou...
Combined score	34



Five whys

1. Why the same path? → Because “Variation” is one deal type and routing is by type.
2. Why no triage? → Because no reason code is captured, so nothing can distinguish an admin change from a restructure.
3. Why no reason code? → Because it was never needed for the workflow, only for MI, and MI did not drive the design.
4. Why does security get re-instructed? → Because the completion template includes it and nobody removes a step that might be needed.
5. Why keep steps that might be needed? → Because the cost of a missed step is visible and the cost of an unnecessary one is not (PP-43).

Root cause

> **No materiality concept; unnecessary steps are invisible while missed steps are not**

Levers (0.9)

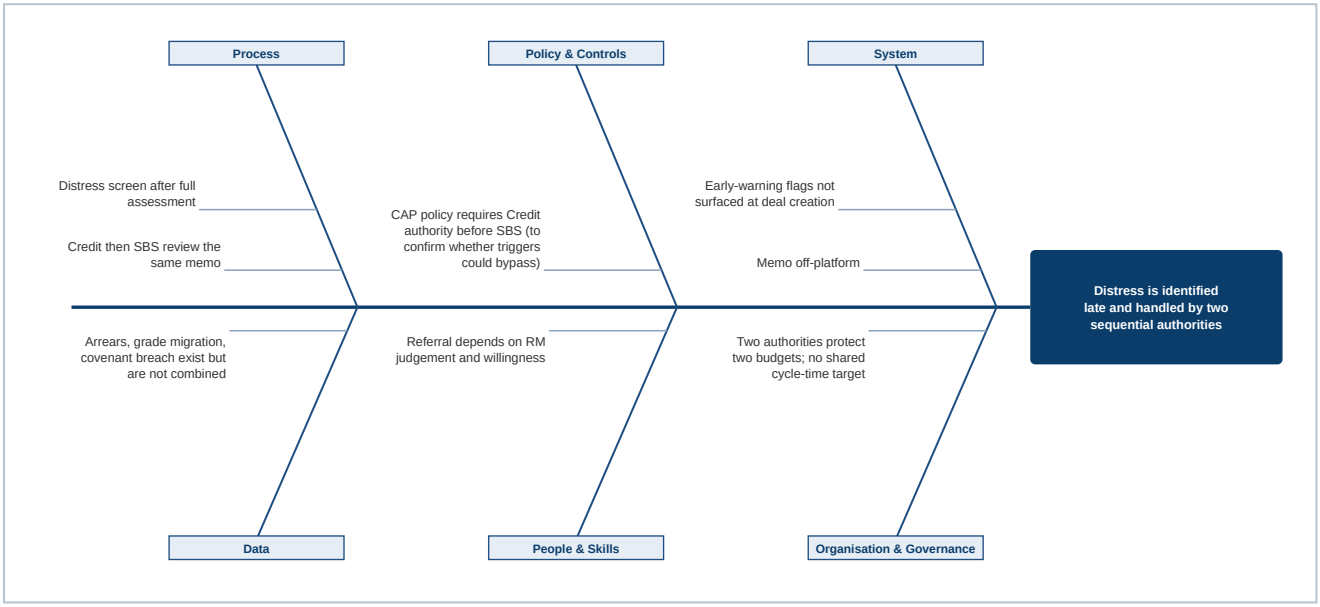
L5, L8

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points’ maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-08 · Distress is identified late and handled by two sequential authorities

Pain points	**PP-34** (10) The trigger for a CAP referral is undefined: RM judgement, arrears, covenant breach or Cre... **PP-17** (8) The financial-distress screen sits after full Credit assessment and applies to existing cu... **PP-21** (8) A CAP referral passes two sequential authorities (Credit, then SBS) each reviewing the sam... **PP-35** (6) The CAP Strategy memo is written off-platform and attached; strategy content is unstructur...
Combined score	32



Five whys

1. Why late? → Because the screen is a Credit step at the end of assessment, not a system flag at the start.
2. Why at the end? → Because it was placed where Credit sees the file, not where data could trigger it.
3. Why two authorities? → Because CAP policy separates the decision to refer from the decision to categorise.
4. Why sequential on the same memo? → Because the workflow transfers the whole deal rather than a referral record, so each authority re-reads it.
5. Why unchanged? → Because the volume (1,516) is small enough that the cost is tolerated, but the risk cost of late referral is not measured.

Root cause

> **Distress handling is file-driven and sequential rather than data-driven and parallel**

Levers (0.9)

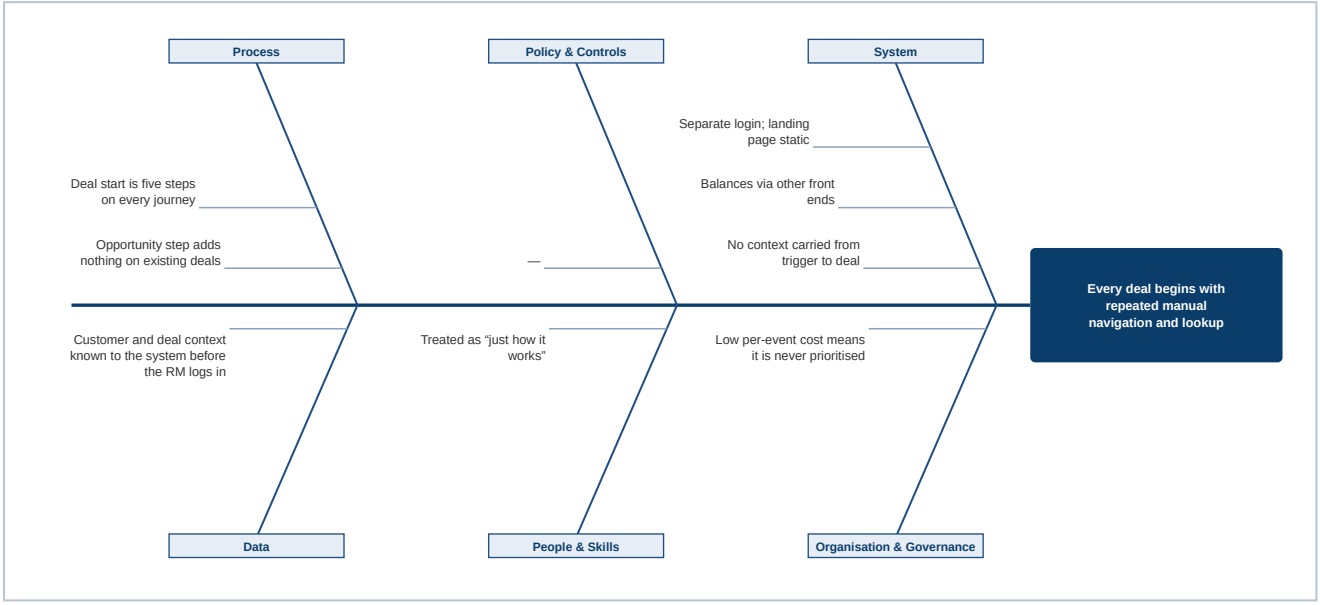
L10

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-09 · Every deal begins with repeated manual navigation and lookup

Pain points	**PP-03** (10) The same five-step deal start (login, landing page, search, locate, retrieve) is performed... **PP-07** (10) Existing balances are sourced from MEO / IMPACS with latency; credit submission may carry ... **PP-06** (2) Opportunity record adds a step without adding information; source notes deals should be cr...
Combined score	22



Five whys

1. Why repeated? → Because every journey begins at the same generic entry point regardless of trigger.
2. Why generic? → Because the trigger (renewal due, customer request) is not a system event, so the system cannot open the deal in context.
3. Why not an event? → Because triggers are reports and emails (PP-04, PP-01).
4. Why tolerated? → Because each repetition costs minutes, and minutes × 26,700 is nobody's budget line.
5. Why nobody's? → Because effort is unmeasured (PP-43).

Root cause

> **Triggers are not system events, so no context flows into the deal start**

Levers (0.9)

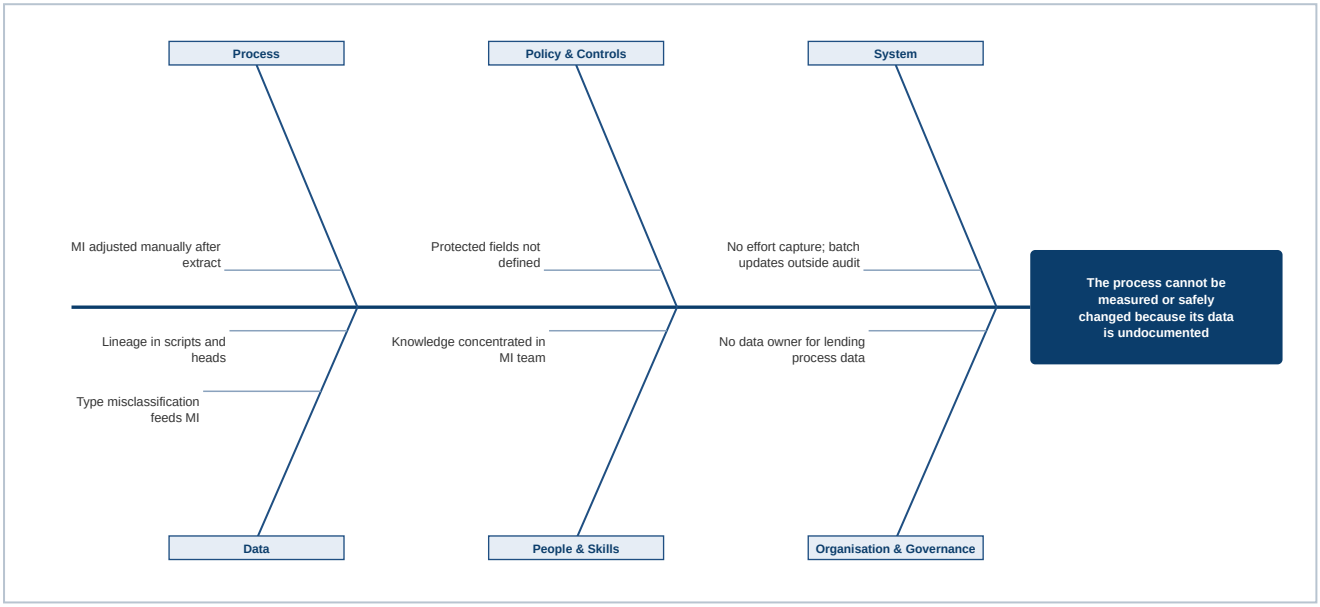
L2

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

RC-10 · The process cannot be measured or safely changed because its data is undocumented

Pain points	**PP-40** (8) Regulatory reporting lineage from BLP is undocumented at field level and operational MI re... **PP-37** (6) Officer codes are reassigned in bulk by batch with no audit trail on the deal; segment att... **PP-43** (15) Effort is invisible: BLP records no touch time, so cost to serve, capacity and the effect ... **PP-42** (2) Deposit opportunities are closed as Won / Declined with no reason code and no pipeline MI;...
Combined score	31



Five whys

1. Why undocumented? → Because reports were built incrementally on extracts, not designed from a data model.
2. Why incrementally? → Because each regulatory change was met with a script change, under time pressure.
3. Why does it matter now? → Because the redesign and replacement will change capture points, and nobody can say which reports break.
4. Why nobody? → Because ownership sits with MI for the extract and with the business for the field, and neither owns the lineage.
5. Why no owner? → Because data ownership was never assigned for BLP; the replacement is the moment to assign it.

Root cause

> **No data ownership or lineage; measurement was never designed in**

Levers (0.9)

L14, L15

Validation

Fishbone causes marked for confirmation in the workshop that owns the pain points' maps; the five-whys chain is re-run with Bank participants. A theme is confirmed when at least two roles independently agree the root cause.

6. Root-cause consolidation

Ten themes resolve to six underlying causes. These are the design problems Phase 2 must solve; the pain points are their symptoms.

Underlying cause	Themes	Pain points (count)	Design principle it implies (for Week 8)	Levers
U1. Routing by deal type, not by risk or materiality	RC-01, RC-06, RC-07	9	Route by risk and change materiality; deal type becomes a parameter on a pattern	L1, L5, L12
U2. Policy lives in documents and judgement, not in rules with evidence	RC-04, RC-01	7	Every control expressed as a rule the system applies and records; no control without equivalence	L3, L9
U3. The system has no concept of time, queues or hand-offs	RC-05, RC-09	8	Every wait has an owner, a timer and a task; triggers are system events	L2, L5, L7
U4. Documents and information requests live outside the system	RC-02, RC-03	9	Generate, deliver, receive and evidence on platform; structured requests with limits	L4, L11
U5. Distress handling is file-driven and sequential	RC-08	4	Data-driven early warning; referral as a record, not a file transfer	L10
U6. Nobody owns the data or the end-to-end measure	RC-10, RC-05	9	Named data owners; capture once; lineage maintained; cycle time and effort measured end to end	L14, L15

6.1 Cause–effect matrix (which cause drives which top pain point)

Pain point	U1	U2	U3	U4	U5	U6
PP-09 Renewals follow the full Deal & Credit flow (analysis, validation, doc…	●	●				
PP-23 Facility letters are generated in BLP but issued manually by the RM as…				●		
PP-04 Renewal is triggered by a report (BDRM), not a system task; renewals s…			●			
PP-08 Deal-type model is worked around: 3 of 11 types carry no live process;…	●					●
PP-15 Delegated-authority determination is manual: the RM reads the matrix a…		●				
PP-18 Variations are not triaged by materiality: a covenant date change and …	●					
PP-39 There are no workflow timers, SLAs or escalations anywhere in the life…			●			●
PP-13 Deal validation does not catch what Credit needs: deals pass validatio…		●		●		
PP-14 The deferral loop (Credit → RM → customer → Credit) is unbounded: no l…			●	●		
PP-16 The Credit queue is invisible: no SLA, no queue position, no visibilit…			●			
PP-11 Credit analytics (debt servicing, classifications, external checks) ar…				●		
PP-12 Requests to the customer for information are made and chased outside t…			●	●		
PP-24 A facility letter not returned within three months sends the deal back…		●		●		
PP-29 Hand-off to Fulfilment is by message; the Fulfilment queue and its SLA…			●			
PP-43 Effort is invisible: BLP records no touch time, so cost to serve, capa…						●

Every top-15 pain point is driven by at least one underlying cause, and U1–U4 between them cover fourteen of the fifteen. This is the case for a small number of structural design decisions in Phase 2 rather than a long list of point fixes.

7. Validation to v1.0 and hypothesis linkage

Week	Activity	Converts
3–5	Workshops WS-02 to WS-11: each map's pain points confirmed, corrected or struck; new ones added with step references	Evidence M → M+W; new entries
3–5	Interviews (15–20) using §2.1; answers coded to pain points	Frequency and impact bands from indicative to testimonial
4–5	Shadowing (5 days) using §2.4 checklist	Practice vs. design; off-platform work confirmed (PP-11, 23, 27)
5–6	Survey free text coded	Frequency by role
5–7	1.4 metrics attached: T4 (PP-16), T5/R4 (PP-23/24), R1–R3 (PP-13/14), R6 (PP-22), T7 (PP-04), T8 (PP-21), R5 (PP-19), R8 (PP-38)	Bands to measured values where a metric exists
6	Root-cause themes re-run with Bank participants (WS-13 for control themes; WG leads for others)	RC confirmed / amended
7	Register frozen; feeds 1.10 and 1.11	v1.0

7.1 What the register says about the hypotheses (pre-validation)

Hypothesis	Pain points	Position at v0.7
A1 Renewals follow full flow	PP-09	Structurally confirmed by maps; share to measure
A3 EPR chains	PP-22	Mechanism confirmed; frequency to measure
A4 Variations heterogeneous	PP-18	Absence of triage confirmed; mix to measure
B1, B2, B3 Deal-type model	PP-03, PP-08, PP-05	Supported by 1.3
C1 Deferral loop	PP-12, 13, 14	Mechanism confirmed; rate to measure
C2 Letters	PP-23, 24, 25, 31	Mechanism confirmed; reset rate to measure
C3 Post-approval change	PP-19	Path undefined; rate to measure
C4 Wait dominates	PP-16, 26, 27, 29, 39	Mechanism confirmed; wait vs touch to measure
D1, D2, D3 Workarounds	PP-07, 11, 25, 36, 37, 38	Supported by 1.7
E1, E2 Controls	PP-02, 10, 15, 20	Supported by 1.6; classification at WS-13
F1, F2 Data	PP-40, 37	Supported by 1.8; confirm with MI

7.2 Exit criteria for v1.0

- Every pain point has evidence from at least two sources, one of which is S4 or S5
- Frequency and impact bands confirmed by the owning working group; measured value attached where a 1.4 metric exists
- Every root-cause theme confirmed by at least two roles
- No pain point without an L2 and step reference; parking-lot items listed separately
- Register accepted by the Business Owner as the agreed statement of what is wrong